- Close curtains around bed. Lower the side rails and help patient assume prone or side lying position (sim's position)
- Expose patient's back, shoulders, upper arms, and buttocks. Cover remainder of body.
- Wash your hands with warm water.
- Inform patient that lotion will feel cool and wet
- Apply hands first to sacral area massaging in circular motion, stroke upwards from buttocks to shoulders
- Continue in one smooth stroke from upper back to arm and laterally alongside of back, down to iliac crest.
- Do not take hands off from patient's back till the end of the procedure.
- Continue massage pattern effleurage for at least 3 minutes.
- Perform petrissage along upward along one side of spine from buttock to shoulders.
- Perform tapotement for 2 minutes.
- Apply other remaining massaging techniques for at least 2 minutes.
- Apply oil or lubricants to back as required.
- Wipe excess lubricant from patients back with bath towel/ tissue.
- Retie gown or assist pajamas.
- Help patient to comfortable position.
- Raise side rails as needed
- Disposed of soiled towel and wash hands.
- Record response to back massage and condition of skin.

8.7.7 Special Consideration

- For patients with history of hypertension and dysarrhythmia asses pulse and blood pressure.
- Consider cultural preferences.
- Do not give massage if any discoloration of skin present.
- A back massage should take about five to ten minutes and can be given with the patient's bath, before bedtime, or at any other time during the day.
- Determine if any allergies or skin sensitivities exist before applying lotion to the patient's skin.
- The greatest relaxation effect of a massage occurs when the rhythm of the massage is coordinated with the patient's breathing.

8.8 Hot and Cold Applications

8.8.1 Definitions

Hot application is the application of hot agent, warmer than skin either in a moist or dry form on the surface of the body to relieve pain and congestion, to provide warmth, to promote suppuration, to promote healing, to decrease muscle tone and to softens the exudates.

Cold application is the application of cold agent, cooler than skin either in a moist or dry form on the surface of the body to relieve pain and body temperature, to anaesthetize an area, to check hemorrhage, to control growth of bacteria, to prevent gangrene, to prevent oedema and reduce inflammation.

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